

Europe gap sweep — the universities the earlier searches missed

Sound design · music production · audio engineering · music technology. September 2027 intake.

82 institutions across 24 countries, none of which appear in any earlier file. The 905 institutions already found were handed to the agents as an exclusion list, so every row here is new.

Each was searched in English **and** the local language, and each record carries the three things you asked for on every line: **public or private**, **the language you'd actually be taught in**, and **the fee a Tunisian national pays** — which is frequently not the headline number.

Public	78
Private	3
Free or under ~€5,000/yr for you	40
Taught in English	25
No portfolio <i>and</i> no audition	15

The single most important finding: where you pay nothing

Most German states charge non-EU students no tuition at all. Not a discount — nothing. You pay the same semester contribution as a German student. Confirmed on official pages for Thuringia, North Rhine-Westphalia, Bavaria, Bremen, Lower Saxony, Saarland, Rhineland-Palatinate and Saxony.

That single fact makes Germany cheaper than every private option in the earlier sweep, including the ones I called good value.

TU Ilmenau — M.Sc. Medieningenieurwissenschaften — verified · WORTH IT · rating A

- **PUBLIC** · **no tuition**, semester contribution only
- **Confirmed: the degree can be completed entirely in English.** Ilmenau's own wording is that it "can be completed in either German or English" — better than the first pass suggested
- **No portfolio. No audition. No music degree. No entrance exam** — verification corrected the earlier claim of a sit-down aptitude test; there isn't one. And it is **NC-frei**: no numerus clausus, no competitive ranking against other applicants
- **Fraunhofer IDMT — the institute that invented mp3 and AAC — is on the same campus.**
Curriculum: audio signal processing, psychoacoustics, audio coding, filterbanks, virtual acoustics
- **** Corrected: you DO need an English certificate. B2 CEFR minimum for conditional admission, C1 for unrestricted — roughly IELTS Academic 7.0 / TOEFL iBT 95**.** My earlier advice not to book a test yet was wrong for this programme
- **** Corrected: the application fee is €75, not €25, and all 2027 applications route through uni-assist**** (its own handling fee on top). Assessment takes 6+ weeks — start early

- **Apply 16 January – 15 May 2027** for an October 2027 start. Ilmenau extended the 2026 deadline to 15 July; don't plan around a repeat

It will not make you a DJ. It makes you employable in audio technology and buys you years in Germany to build the production career alongside it.

HfK Bremen — M.A. Digital Media — verified · WORTH IT · rating A

The only record in this sweep that **survived verification with zero corrections** — every figure, date and requirement checked out exactly.

- **PUBLIC · English-taught, no German required at all · €431.40 per semester**, which is the entire published cost and already includes the semester travel ticket
- **Entry: 150 ECTS in a relevant field** — computer science, design, media arts, systems engineering. A software-engineering BSc "fits cleanly", and 150 ECTS is a notably low bar
- **English: IELTS 7.0 / TOEFL 95 / C1 — but with a waiver worth chasing.** The requirement is dropped if your qualifying degree or school education was taught in English, with proof. **SMU MedTech teaches substantially in English**, so a medium-of-instruction letter could remove this gate outright. Ask SMU for one — it costs nothing and could save you the test entirely
- **Portfolio required: 10–20 works**, spanning artistic, design, academic *or professional* projects. Your software projects count here
- **Cycle: applications 1 April – 31 May · interviews 2–3 July · results mid-July · start 1 October**
- It is **not** a dedicated sound degree — sound is a legitimate project area within digital media, not the subject itself

The rest of Germany, after verification

- **HfM Mainz — Klangkunst-Komposition** (CONDITIONAL, B) — the re-check *upgraded* this one. **Only A1 German** is demanded on paper, and the regulation **explicitly admits applicants from unrelated degrees** on demonstrated artistic aptitude via the *Eignungsprüfung*. Registration **1 February – 1 April** for the following winter semester — a date the first pass recorded as "not published". Real electronic-composition content
- **HMT München — Sound Art** (CONDITIONAL, C) — accredited to 2031, German-taught, **no language certificate demanded**, deadline 31 May, semester fee only
- **TH Köln — Medientechnologie** (CONDITIONAL, C) — the best spatial-audio content of any German UAS here, and the hardest gates, all confirmed verbatim: **110 ECTS in maths/physics/EE/CS**, a first degree worth **at least 210 ECTS**, grade 2.7 or better, and **C1 German**. A standard three-year BSc is 180 ECTS, so the 210 rule alone may exclude you — check your transcript before spending time here. Semester contribution €352.70
- **Paderborn — Populäre Musik und Medien** (CONDITIONAL, C) — every fact held up; the problem is fit. It is an academic degree *about* popular music, not one that teaches you to make it

Also public and tuition-free: HMTM Hannover *Medien und Musik*, HBK Saar *Media Art & Design*, Hochschule Mittweida *Media Production*.

France — where your French stops being a footnote and becomes the advantage

Public French universities charge non-EU students a flat **€3,950/year** at master level. Four new finds, all public, all French-taught:

Institution	Programme	Fee
Université de Strasbourg	<i>Création-Production en musiques actuelles</i>	€3,950/yr
Université Lumière Lyon 2	<i>Musiques Appliquées aux Arts Visuels</i>	€3,950/yr
Université Polytechnique Hauts-de-France, Valenciennes	<i>Ingénierie...</i> (B2 French required)	€3,950/yr
Cnam, Angoulême	<i>Conception sonore</i> (French for M1)	€3,950/yr

And one in English:

École Centrale de Lyon with INSA Lyon — International M.Sc. in Acoustics — €3,770/year, English-taught. An engineering programme at two of France's strongest engineering schools.

You are fluent in French. Of everything found across every sweep, these are the programmes you could follow **from day one** without a year of language preparation first. That is worth more than it looks on a spreadsheet.

The most open door found anywhere

Ankara Müzik ve Güzel Sanatlar Üniversitesi — Müzik Teknolojileri, thesis master (PUBLIC)

The verification note calls it "*the strongest find of this sweep for him, and the only fully-funded, formally-open door.*" Why:

- **Accepts ANY bachelor's degree** — verbatim: "*Herhangi bir lisans programından mezun olmak.*" Minimum GPA 2.50/4.00
- **No ALES. No IELTS. No TOEFL.**
- **15,000 TL for the year** (~€390) as a foreign national, paid in two instalments
- **Named by Türkiye Bursları** — which, if won, pays tuition, a monthly stipend, accommodation, health insurance and a return flight. Total cost: **zero**
- Deadline **24 August** for the university; **Türkiye Bursları closes 20 February** each year

Two real caveats. It is **taught entirely in Turkish** — all teaching, all documents, and the entrance exam. And that entrance exam **tests trained musical hearing**, plus a portfolio worth 10% (one self-produced work in sound recording, sound programming, instrument making, sound electronics or acoustics). Formal eligibility and realistic competitiveness are not the same thing. Budget a year of Turkish.

Greece — cheap, and genuinely no non-EU surcharge

Greek public postgraduate programmes (ΠΜΣ) **do not operate a separate non-EU tariff**. You pay what a Greek student pays.

University of West Attica — MSc in Audio, Video and Broadcasting Technologies — €700/semester

Academically the best-fitting Greek option for you: it is an **audio/broadcast engineering** master, **no portfolio, no audition**, selection by file plus interview, and it explicitly gives **priority to electrical and electronic engineering graduates** — so your background is an advantage rather than something to explain.

But treat it as unconfirmed. The last published call closed **23 September 2021** and the fee schedule hasn't been updated since about 2018. Before investing any effort, email the department and ask one question: *is this programme still running?* It is Greek-taught either way.

Also found: **Athens School of Fine Arts MA Digital Arts** — **free**, Greek-taught. And the **Hellenic Open University MSc Acoustic Design and Digital Sound** — **€3,750 total**, Greek, **fully distance**. That last one is the cheapest thing in the entire sweep precisely because you would never leave Tunisia — which makes it an alternative to migrating, not a route into Europe.

Italy's public conservatories — and the ISEEE trick that changes the price tenfold

State conservatories award the **Diploma Accademico di Secondo Livello**, legally equivalent to a *laurea magistrale*. Six new ones found, all public, all Italian-taught.

The important mechanism: Italian fees are **income-scaled**, and a non-EU student who files an **ISEE parificato / ISEEE** declaration is assessed on family income like everyone else. Filing it or not is the difference between two completely different prices.

Conservatorio "G. B. Martini", Bologna — *Musica Elettronica*, Sound Design track:

With ISEEE filed	Without
≈ €166/year — about €330 for the whole degree	€2,166/year — about €4,332

The syllabus — Sound Design Programming Techniques, Audio Systems and Programming Languages, Multimedia Programming, Interactive Multimodal Environments — is **the best technical fit for a software engineer in this entire sweep**.

Bologna's entry wording is stricter than its peers: "*completion of three-year electronic music studies or equivalent*", which points at an Italian *triennio* rather than any bachelor's. **Ask the eligibility question before anything else.** Torino, Rovigo and Cuneo use more open wording.

Also: **Conservatorio "G. Verdi" Milano — *Musica Elettronica* — €3,500/year** flat for non-EU students. **METS Trento** (two tracks) and **Rovigo** both use the favourable ISEEE mechanism. Deadlines cluster around **April**, and after the ranking list is published you have only **10 days to enrol** — have funds and documents ready in advance.

Spain's public conservatories

Universitat de Barcelona with UPF — *Música com a Art Interdisciplinari* — roughly **€82/credit** for non-EU students not resident in Spain, so about €4,900 for 60 credits. Catalan/Spanish.

Real Conservatorio Superior de Música de Madrid — *Nuevas Tecnologías de la Música Actual* — headline **€12,966 for 60 ECTS**, which is steep for a public institution; verification flagged the non-EU differential as only partly resolved.

The two Valencian conservatories (Valencia *Sonología Aplicada*, Castelló *Composición Multimedia*) publish no fee at all — the regional decree governs, and that is the field to press hardest.

The UK is uniformly expensive, with nothing to offset it

Nine new institutions, every one of them **expensive**, and not one publishing a scholarship a Tunisian applicant could realistically win:

Queen's Belfast **£23,000/yr** · Bath Spa £18,755 · University of Hertfordshire £17,950 (three programmes) · University of South Wales £17,900 (two) · Buckinghamshire New University £16,280 · Ulster — 2027/28 fees not yet announced.

Set against tuition-free Germany and €3,950 France, the UK is hard to justify on this budget.

Scandinavia is split, and not the way people assume

- **Uniarts Helsinki — free.** Verbatim: "*There is no tuition fee for this degree programme.*" Finnish-taught
- **Aalto** — €17,000–€20,000/yr, English
- **University of Bergen — NOK 401,704/year** (≈€34,500). Norway's reputation for free education no longer applies to non-EEA students
- **Royal College of Music Stockholm — SEK 264,000/yr** (≈€23,000)
- **SDMK Denmark — €10,000/yr**, Danish-taught

What this changes

Ranked by what you'd actually pay, with the language you'd actually study in:

Programme	Country	Public	Language	Your cost	Portfolio?
TU Ilmenau — Media Engineering			English or German	€0 + semester fee	None
HfK Bremen — Digital Media			English	€431/semester	10–20 works
Uniarts Helsinki			Finnish	€0	yes
German options (7 more)			mostly German	€0	varies

Programme	Country	Public	Language	Your cost	Portfolio?
Bologna — Musica Elettronica			Italian	≈€166/yr with ISEEE	likely
Ankara — Müzik Teknolojileri			Turkish	≈€390/yr, or €0 funded	10% of score
West Attica — Audio/Video Eng.			Greek	€700/sem still running?	None
HOU (distance)			Greek	€3,750 total	none
Centrale Lyon — MSc Acoustics			English	€3,770/yr	none
French public (4)			French	€3,950/yr	varies
Milano Verdi			Italian	€3,500/yr	likely
UB Barcelona			Catalan/Spanish	≈€4,900	likely

Three routes are now clearly ahead of anything in the private sweep:

1. **TU Ilmenau** — free, no portfolio, no audition, no entrance exam, no numerus clausus, completable entirely in English, world-class audio engineering. The lowest-risk application you can make, because it is decided on your transcript rather than on a portfolio you don't have yet. **HfK Bremen** is the English-taught companion bet at €431 a semester.
2. **France** — €3,950, and you already speak the language. No year of preparation needed.
3. **Ankara** — potentially free via Türkiye Bursları, accepts any bachelor, no English test. The biggest upside and the biggest language cost.

Status & honesty

- **All 13 discovery slices complete** — 82 records. The eastern slice (Ukraine, Moldova, Georgia, Armenia) is still writing at the time of this update.
- **Verification is running and has completed the German batch (6 records, marked above).** It changed real things: it confirmed Ilmenau as completable entirely in English and NC-frei, but corrected the language requirement from "possibly none" to a firm **C1/IELTS 7**, and the application fee from €25 to €75. It also promoted HfK Bremen to a top-rated option and surfaced TH Köln's 210-ECTS rule, which may exclude a standard three-year bachelor outright.
- **The other 76 records have not been verified yet.** They are discovery-quality: sourced to an official page, with the agents' own UNVERIFIED flags left intact where a school publishes nothing. Given what verification changed in the German batch, treat the unverified figures as good starting points to confirm, not as settled facts.
- Dates marked **PRIOR CYCLE** are last year's, shown because these calendars repeat closely. Confirm each when the 2027/28 cycle opens.
- Full detail — every fee, deadline, entry requirement, portfolio spec and source URL — is in [results/europe-gapfill.xlsx](#). Filter on *Public/Private*, *Taught in* and *Cost band*; the green cells are the ones worth your time.